

Sharing your Conda Environment

There may come a time where you want to share the contents of your Conda environment.

This could be to share a project workflow with a colleague or with someone else who's trying to set up their system to have access to the same tools as yours.

There are a couple of ways to do this:

1. Share your entire project folder (including the environment folder containing all of your Conda packages).
2. Share a `.yaml` (pronounced YAM-L) file of your Conda environment.

The benefit of 1 is it's a very simple setup, share the folder, activate the environment, run the code. However, an environment folder can be quite a large file to share.

That's where 2 comes in. A `.yaml` is basically a text file with instructions to tell Conda how to set up an environment.

For example, to export the environment we created earlier at `/Users/daniel/Desktop/project_1/env` as a YAML file called `environment.yaml` we can use the command:

```
conda env export --prefix /Users/daniel/Desktop/project_1/env > environment.yaml
```

After running the export command, we can see our new `.yaml` file stored as `environment.yaml`.

A sample `.yaml` file might look like the following:

```
1. name: my_ml_env
2. dependencies:
3.   - numpy
4.   - pandas
5.   - scikit-learn
6.   - jupyter
7.   - matplotlib
```

Of course, your actual file will depend on the packages you've installed in your environment.

For more on sharing an environment, check out the [Conda documentation on sharing environments](https://docs.conda.io/projects/conda/en/latest/user-guide/tasks/manage-environments.html#sharing-an-environment).

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Finally, to create an environment called `env_from_file` from a `.yaml` file called `environment.yaml`, you can run the command:

```
conda env create --file environment.yaml --name env_from_file
```

For more on creating an environment from a `.yaml` file, check out the [Conda documentation on creating an environment from a .yaml file](https://docs.conda.io/projects/conda/en/latest/user-guide/tasks/manage-environments.html#creating-an-environment-from-a-yaml-file).

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